



DAK GURU

A Self Learning Portal

www.dakguru.com

Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018

(As amended and in force)

Updated up to G.S.R. 214(E), dated 02.04.2025

Verified against primary sources as on 05 September 2026

Amendment History of these Rules

Instrument	Date	Short title / SB Order	Provisions affected
G.S.R. 1003(E)	05.10.2018	Principal Rules	Original publication
G.S.R. 238(E)	31.03.2023	First Amendment Rules, 2023 (SB Order 08/2023)	Rule 6(1) substituted — Aadhaar & PAN/Form 60 identification
G.S.R. 488(E)	03.07.2023	Second Amendment Rules, 2023 (SB Order 16/2023)	Rules 5(2), 5(7), 8(3), 10(4), 13(3), 14(9), 15(6), 15(7), 24(1)(a); Schedule-I (Form GSPR-16) inserted
G.S.R. 214(E)	02.04.2025	Amendment Rules, 2025 (SB Order 05/2025)	Schedule-II — nomination cancellation/change fee of ₹50 deleted



MINISTRY OF FINANCE

(Department of Economic Affairs)

NOTIFICATION — New Delhi, the 5th October, 2018

G.S.R. 1003(E).— In exercise of the powers conferred by section 15 of the Government Savings Promotion Act, 1873 (5 of 1873), the Central Government hereby makes the following rules, namely:—

1. Short title and commencement

- (1) These rules may be called the Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018.
- (2) They shall come into force on the date of their publication in the Official Gazette.

2. Applicability

These rules shall apply to the schemes listed in the Schedule appended to the Government Savings Promotion Act, 1873 (5 of 1873).

3. Definitions

- (1) In these rules, unless the context otherwise requires,—
 - (a) "Accounts Office" means an office of a Government Savings Bank authorised to open an account;
 - (b) "Act" means the Government Savings Promotion Act, 1873 (5 of 1873);
 - (c) "Eligible Balance" means the amount of balance at the credit of the account, including interest accrued thereon, after effecting recoveries on account of outstanding principal and interest, if any;
 - (d) "Form" means a form appended to these rules;
 - (e) "Joint Account" means an account opened in the names of more than one and up to three individuals;
 - (f) "Matured account" means an account, which has completed its term or extended term and has become due for payment;
 - (g) "Non-resident Indian" means an individual being a citizen of India or a person of Indian origin who is not a "resident" as per the provisions of the Income-tax Act, 1961 (43 of 1961);

(h) "Officially Valid Document" means the passport, the driving licence, the Voter's Identity Card issued by the Election Commission of India, job card issued under Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act signed by an officer of the State Government, the letter issued by the National Population Register containing details of name and address;

(i) "Operation of an Account" means opening of, deposit in, transfer of or withdrawal from an Account;

(j) "Passbook" means a document, in physical or electronic form, issued by an Accounts Office containing particulars of the depositor and details of transactions made in that account;

(k) "Single Account" means an account opened in the name of one individual;

(l) "Transfer" means transfer of an account of a depositor from one Accounts Office to another Accounts Office;

(m) "Schedule" means a schedule annexed to this rule.

(2) The words and expressions used herein and not defined but defined in the Act shall have the same meanings as assigned to them in the Act.

4. Eligibility to open an account

(1) An adult who is a resident citizen of India is eligible to open an account under these rules:

Provided that an account may be opened by a guardian on behalf of a minor or person of unsound mind:

Provided further that the guardian as well as the minor or a person of unsound mind shall be the resident citizen of India.

(2) A minor who has attained the age of ten years may open and operate an account in accordance with the provisions of a Savings Scheme.

(3) If a depositor in a single account, or any of the depositors in a joint account, or either the guardian of minor or person of unsound mind or minor depositor, as the case may be, subsequently becomes Non-resident Indian during the period the account is in operation, the account may be continued till its maturity and the benefits available to the depositor in the said account shall be available only on non-repatriation basis and the

account shall not be allowed to be extended or continued beyond maturity, even if such extension or continuation is and otherwise permissible, and no interest shall be payable after the date of its maturity.

(4) If a depositor in a single account, or any of the depositors in a joint account, or either the guardian or a minor depositor or a depositor who is a person of unsound mind, as the case may be, ceases to be a citizen of India, the account shall be closed or deemed to be closed from the last day of the month preceding the month in which the depositor ceases to be a citizen of India.

✂ CORRECTION — Sub-rules (3) and (4) above have been restored to the text of the principal rules as notified vide G.S.R. 1003(E) dated 05.10.2018 (Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II — Sec. 3(i)). An earlier draft mis-stated both, showing the account as “deemed to be closed from the day” of the change with interest only up to that day. Correct position: on becoming a Non-resident Indian [4(3)] the account continues till maturity, benefits are available only on non-repatriation basis, and it cannot be extended beyond maturity with no interest after maturity; on ceasing to be a citizen of India [4(4)] the account is closed or deemed closed from the last day of the month preceding the month of cessation. These sub-rules are not affected by G.S.R. 238(E), 488(E) or 214(E).

5. Opening of an account

(1) An account may be opened by the depositor either by visiting the Accounts Office in person or through permissible electronic modes including internet or mobile banking application of the respective Government Savings Bank.

(2) An eligible individual desiring to open an account may do so by making an application in Form-1 to the Accounts Office along with the following documents, namely:—

- (a) proof of age of minor in case of account opened by a minor or on behalf of a minor;
- (b) a recent passport size photograph;

Provided that, in case of account opened on behalf of a minor, recent passport size photograph of the guardian only shall be submitted;

▣ AMENDMENT FLAG — The proviso to clause (b) above was inserted by the Government Savings Promotion General (Second Amendment) Rules, 2023, vide G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (w.e.f. 03.07.2023), circulated by SB Order 16/2023.

- (c) a certificate from Superintendent of mental hospital where a person of unsound mind is confined or treated, as the case may be, in case the account is opened on behalf of the person of unsound mind;

- (d) amount of deposit, accompanied by a Pay-in-Slip; and
 - (e) identity documents specified in rule 6.
- (3) An illiterate or a blind or visually challenged individual desiring to open an account shall personally visit the Accounts Office for authentication of his signature or thumb impression by the Accounts Office.
- (4) An illiterate depositor shall be assisted by the Authorised Officer of Accounts Office for opening (filling up of forms etc.) and operating the account and thumb impression of the illiterate depositor shall be obtained on the application form and other documents in the presence of the Authorised Officer who shall attest the same.
- (5) A blind or visually challenged or illiterate depositor may open joint account with a literate depositor.
- (6) The persons with autism, cerebral palsy, mental retardation and multiple disabilities as defined in section 2 of the National Trust for Welfare of Persons with Autism, Cerebral Palsy, Mental Retardation and Multiple Disabilities Act, 1999 (44 of 1999) may open and operate the account through their legal guardian appointed by the District Court under section 14 of the said Act or by the Local Level Committee constituted under section 13 of the said Act.
- (7) Change of name or surname may be allowed by the account office by following the procedure laid down by the Reserve Bank of India for change of name or surname in Bank Savings Account.

■ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — Sub-rule (7) was inserted by G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (Second Amendment Rules, 2023; SB Order 16/2023), w.e.f. 03.07.2023.

6. Identification of depositor

(1) In addition to the documents mentioned in sub-rule (2) of rule 5, an individual shall also submit to the Accounts Office, the following identity documents containing proof of identity and address for the purpose of opening an account, namely: —

(a) the Aadhaar Number issued by the Unique Identification Authority of India:

Provided that where the Aadhaar Number has not been assigned to an individual, he shall furnish proof of application of enrolment for Aadhaar and —

(i) if a depositor desires to open an account, he shall submit his Aadhaar number to the Accounts Office within a period of six months from the date of opening of account; and

(ii) if a depositor has already opened an account and has not submitted his Aadhaar number to the Accounts Office, he shall do so within a period of six months with effect from the 1st day of April, 2023,

and in the event of failure of the depositor to submit the Aadhaar number within the specified time, his account shall become inoperative till the time he submits the Aadhaar number to the Accounts Office.

(b) the Permanent Account Number (PAN) or Form 60 as defined in the Income-tax Rules, 1962:

Provided that the depositor who has not submitted the Permanent Account Number at the time of opening of an account, shall submit the same to the Accounts Office within a period of two months from the date of any of the following events, whichever is the earliest, namely:—

- (i) the balance at any point of time in the account exceeds fifty thousand rupees; or
- (ii) the aggregate of all credits in the account in any financial year exceeds one lakh rupees; or
- (iii) the aggregate of all withdrawals and transfers in a month from the account exceeds ten thousand rupees,

and in the event of failure of the depositor to submit the Permanent Account Number within the specified time, his account shall cease to be operational till the time he submits the Permanent Account Number to the Accounts Office.

(c) any other document as may be considered necessary by the Accounts Office including those related to the nature of business and financial status of the depositor.

■ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — Rule 6, sub-rule (1) was substituted in entirety by the Government Savings Promotion General (Amendment) Rules, 2023, vide G.S.R. 238(E) dated 31.03.2023 (w.e.f. publication), circulated by SB Order 08/2023. This is the only provision amended by G.S.R. 238(E).

(2) In case the Aadhaar Number or Permanent Account Number submitted by the depositor does not have the present address, the depositor shall submit a certified copy of an officially valid document containing the current address.

Provided that if the officially valid document submitted by the depositor does not contain updated address, any of the following documents, or the equivalent e-documents thereof, shall be deemed to be officially valid documents for the limited purpose of proof of address, namely:—

- (i) utility bill which is not more than two months old of any service provider (electricity, telephone, post-paid mobile phone, piped gas, water bill); or
- (ii) property or Municipal tax receipt; or
- (iii) pension or family pension payment orders issued to retired employees by Government Departments or Public Sector Undertakings, if they contain the address; or
- (iv) letter of allotment of accommodation from employer issued by the State Government or Central Government Departments, statutory or regulatory bodies, public sector undertakings, scheduled commercial banks, financial institutions and listed companies, and leave and licence agreements with such employers allotting official accommodation;

Provided further that the depositor shall submit Aadhaar Number or Permanent Account Number, or a certified copy of an officially valid document containing updated current address within a period of three months of submitting the documents specified above.

- (3) In case of a Joint Account, identity document of all the depositors opening the account jointly shall be obtained by the Accounts Office.
- (4) In case of an account opened on behalf of a minor or a person of unsound mind the identity documents of the guardian shall be furnished to the Accounts Office.
- (5) Where an account is opened through an authorised agent, the agent shall also affix his signatures and mention the particulars of his agency on the identity documents, alongside those of the depositor.
- (6) In case of change of address, the depositor shall submit the relevant identity document with updated address within a period of three months.

7. Mode of deposit

- (1) A deposit in an account may be made—

- (i) in cash in Indian rupees; or

(ii) by means of a crossed cheque, a demand draft or a pay order drawn in favour of the authorised officer of the Accounts Office; or

(iii) by submitting a signed withdrawal Form in respect of a savings account standing in the same Accounts Office; or

(iv) by electronic transfer permitted by the Reserve Bank of India in respect of similar transactions in commercial banks.

(2) In case of deposit by means of a cheque, the date of realisation of the cheque shall be the date of deposit.

(3) Each deposit except that made through online shall be accompanied by a duly filled in deposit form as may be prescribed by the Government Savings Bank and the counterfoil of the deposit form shall be returned to the depositor duly stamped as a token of having received the deposit.

(4) Where the deposit is made by means of an outstation cheque or instrument, collection charges, as applicable, shall be payable by the depositor on actual basis, either by debit to the savings account or by means of separate remittance.

8. Types of accounts

(1) An account may be opened either as a Single Account or as a Joint Account.

(2) On the basis of mode of operation, Joint Accounts shall be of two types, namely: —

(i) Joint 'A' type, to be operated by all the depositors or the surviving depositors jointly; and

(ii) Joint 'B' type, to be operated by any of the depositors or the surviving depositors severally.

(3) An account opened as a Single Account cannot be subsequently converted into a Joint Account or vice versa:

Provided that, conversion of Joint Account into single account shall be allowed only in case of a single surviving Joint Account holder.

■ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — Sub-rule (3) was substituted by G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (Second Amendment Rules, 2023; SB Order 16/2023), w.e.f. 03.07.2023, to add the proviso permitting conversion of a joint account into a single account in case of a single surviving joint holder.

(4) A depositor in a single account under a Savings Scheme desirous of opening a joint account under the same Savings Scheme may do so subject to the overall ceiling on the amount of deposit or the number of accounts that can be opened by an individual under that Savings Scheme.

(5) A depositor in a Joint Account under a Savings Scheme, desirous of opening a Single Account under the same Savings Scheme, may do so subject to the overall ceiling on the amount of deposit, and the number of accounts that can be opened by an individual under that Savings Scheme.

9. Payment of interest

(1) The deposits made in an account shall earn interest at the rate, as may be notified by the Central Government, from time to time, in respect of the Savings Scheme concerned.

(2) No interest shall be payable on an account opened or maintained, or on a deposit made, in contravention of these rules.

(3) Interest shall be calculated in the manner as provided in the Savings Scheme.

(4) If a depositor in a single account, or any of the depositors in a joint account, or either the guardian or minor depositor or depositor who is person of unsound mind in an account opened on behalf of a minor or a person of unsound mind, as the case may be, subsequently becomes Non-resident Indian during the period the account is in operation, the account shall earn interest at applicable rate till its maturity and no interest after the date of maturity shall be payable on such accounts and the benefits available to the depositor shall be available only on non-repatriation basis.

(5) If a depositor in a single account, or any of the depositors in a joint account, or either the guardian or minor depositor or depositor who is a person of unsound mind, in an account opened on behalf of a minor or a person of unsound mind, as the case may be, ceases to be a citizen of India, the account shall be closed or deemed to be closed from the last day of the month preceding the month in which the depositor ceases to be a citizen of India and interest at the rate applicable to the Post Office Savings Account shall be payable on such accounts till its closure.

✎ CORRECTION — Sub-rules (4) and (5) above have been restored to the text of the principal rules as notified vide G.S.R. 1003(E) dated 05.10.2018. An earlier draft wrongly showed interest as payable only “up to the day” of the change. Correct position: on becoming a Non-resident Indian [9(4)] the account earns interest at the applicable rate till maturity, no interest is payable after maturity, and benefits are on non-repatriation

basis; on ceasing to be a citizen of India [9(5)] the account is closed or deemed closed from the last day of the month preceding the month of cessation, and interest at the Post Office Savings Account rate is payable on such accounts till its closure. Not affected by any amendment (G.S.R. 238(E)/488(E)/214(E)).

(6) In an account which has matured but not closed, the eligible balance in the account shall continue to earn interest at the rate applicable to the Post Office Savings Account, till the closure of the account.

(7) Any interest credited erroneously to an account shall be reversed immediately on the detection by the Accounts Office under written intimation to the depositor.

10. Operation of an account opened in the name of a minor

(1) An account opened in the name of a minor shall be operated by, —

- (i) the guardian, if opened by the guardian;
- (ii) the minor, if opened by the minor.

(2) In case of an account opened in the name of a minor by the guardian and if the minor attains majority during the period the account is in operation, the account shall be operated by the depositor on attaining majority and where the account was opened by the guardian, the depositor shall submit fresh application form along with the Know Your Customer documents to the Accounts Office.

(3) In the event of the death of the minor or a person of unsound mind, the eligible balance shall be paid to the nominee:

Provided that in case of accounts opened before the 1st April, 2018, wherein no nomination was permissible, the eligible balance shall be paid to the guardian.

(4) In the event of death of guardian or on order from any Court of Law in any case of change in the guardian, the succeeding guardian shall be eligible to operate the account of the minor or the person of unsound mind as the case may be.

■ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — Sub-rule (4) was substituted by G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (Second Amendment Rules, 2023; SB Order 16/2023), w.e.f. 03.07.2023, to expressly cover change of guardian on order of a Court of Law.

11. Operation of an account by depositors suffering from physical infirmity or by differently-abled persons

(1) A depositor who suffers from any physical infirmity or is with differently-abled conditions, making him incapable of operating the account himself, may at the time of opening of account or subsequently authorise any other individual to operate the account on his behalf:

Provided that such authorisation, along with the extent of authorisation, shall be made in writing by the depositor to the authorised officer of the Accounts Office, together with attested specimen signature or thumb impression of the individual so authorised.

(2) Authorisation given under sub-rule (1) may be withdrawn or varied at any time by the depositor by submitting a fresh authorisation.

12. Withdrawal from an account

(1) At the time of payment of maturity proceeds or partial withdrawal or interest, the depositor shall affix his signature or thumb impression in the presence of the authorised officer who shall verify the same with the specimen available with the Accounts Office.

(2) In the case of an account opened on behalf of a minor or a person of unsound mind, any withdrawal during the minority or the lunacy of the depositor, as the case may be, shall be permitted to the guardian on furnishing the following certificate, namely:—

"Certified that the amount sought to be withdrawn is required for the use of Mr./Ms. who is a minor or a person of unsound mind and is alive on this day."

(3) Payment of partial withdrawal of the eligible amount or payment of interest may be made by any of the means specified in sub-rule (2) of rule 19.

13. Transfer of an account

(1) An account opened under these rules may be transferred from one Accounts Office to another Accounts Office, whether under the same Government Savings Bank or another, anywhere in India by submitting an application in Form-5 to the Accounts Office where the account stands or to the Accounts Office where the account is intended to be transferred.

(2) In case the application for transfer is submitted to an Accounts Office where the account is intended to be transferred, the said Accounts Office shall forward the request of the depositor to the Accounts Office where the account stands.

(3) In case of transfer of an account from one Government Savings Bank to another, the Accounts Office where the account stands, on receipt of such request shall effect the transfer immediately, and forward the following documents to the Accounts Office where the account is to be transferred, namely:—

- (i) Account Opening Form or Certificate of non-availability of account opening form by the Account Office and in such cases all the information appearing in account opening form shall be verified by the transferor Accounts Office;
- (ii) Specimen signatures of the depositors;
- (iii) Particulars of nomination;
- (iv) Identity documents;
- (v) Updated Account Statement or Ledger;
- (vi) Certified copy of Savings Certificate, in case of Savings Certificate;
- (vii) Pay Order or Demand Draft in respect of the balance at the credit of the account in favour of transferee Accounts Office.

■ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — In sub-rule (3): clause (i) was amended (to add the certificate-of-non-availability route) and clause (vii) was amended (to add the words “in favour of transferee Accounts Office”) by G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (Second Amendment Rules, 2023; SB Order 16/2023), w.e.f. 03.07.2023.

14. Nomination

(1) A depositor in a Single Account, or the depositors in a joint account, as the case may be, shall nominate one or more individuals as nominee but not exceeding four individuals, who in the event of death of the depositor or all the depositors, shall be entitled to receive the eligible balance in the account. Such nomination shall be made at the time of opening of the account by furnishing the following information in Form-10:

- (a) name(s) of the nominee(s);
- (b) percentage share each nominee shall be entitled to;

(c) whether the nominee shall receive the amount as a beneficiary with absolute and exclusive right of ownership, or as a trustee for the benefit of the legal heirs of depositor.

(2) Where the nominee is a minor, the depositors making the nomination, by furnishing the necessary particulars in Form-10, shall appoint an individual to receive payment of the eligible balance in the event of death of the depositor or depositors during the minority of the nominee.

(3) The nomination made under sub-rule (1) may be varied by the depositors by making a fresh application in Form-10, together with the Passbook, to the Accounts Office any time before the maturity of the account.

(4) In case of accounts, except those in the name of a minor or a person of unsound mind, opened before the 1st April, 2018, and where no nomination has been made, the depositor shall do so immediately and where the depositor dies without making any nomination, the eligible balance shall be paid in the manner specified in rule 15.

(5) In case of an account opened by a minor or on behalf of a minor or a person of unsound mind, as the case may be, the nomination shall be made by the guardian, who may nominate any individual, including himself:

Provided that in respect of such accounts opened before the 1st April, 2018, no nomination shall be allowed and in the event of the death of the depositor, the eligible amount shall be paid to the guardian.

(6) Any nomination made under sub-rule (1) shall stand cancelled under the following circumstances, namely:—

(i) death of all the nominees;

(ii) transfer of the account as security under rule 16.

(7) A fresh nomination shall be required to be made under the circumstances enumerated in sub-rule (6).

(8) The thumb impression of an illiterate depositor at the time of making nomination under sub-rules (1) and (7), or altering the nomination in terms of sub-rule (3), shall be attested by two witnesses. No witness shall be required in case of a literate depositor for the purpose.

(9) Non-resident Indians shall be eligible to be nominated as nominee subject to the condition that payment to such nominee/s shall be on non-repatriation basis.

■ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — Sub-rule (9) was inserted by G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (Second Amendment Rules, 2023; SB Order 16/2023), w.e.f. 03.07.2023.

15. Payment on the death of depositor

(1) In the event of death of the depositor of a single account or of all the depositors in a joint account, the eligible balance in the account shall be payable as specified in sub-rules (2) to (7).

(2) If a nomination made under rule 14 is in force at the time of death of the depositor of a single account or all the depositors of a joint account, the nominee may make an application in Form-11 to the Accounts Office, together with the proof of death of the depositor or depositors, for payment of the eligible balance.

(3) If there are two or more surviving nominees, the eligible balance shall be paid in the proportion as specified by the depositor while making the nomination, and if no such proportion or share is specified, in equal proportion to all the surviving nominees.

(4) If any nominee dies, his specified share in the eligible balance shall be distributed among the surviving nominees in the same proportion as their specified shares.

(5) Where the surviving nominee is a minor, the payment shall be made to a person appointed by the depositor under sub-rule (2) of rule 14 to receive such payment and, if no such person has been appointed, to the guardian of the minor for the use of the minor.

(6) If a depositor dies and there is no nomination in force at the time of his death, and the probate of his will or letters of administration of estate or a succession certificate granted under the Indian Succession Act, 1925 (39 of 1925), or legal heir certificate issued by the revenue authority not below the rank of Tahsildar having jurisdiction, is not produced within six months from the date of death of the depositor to the Authorised Officer of the Accounts Office where the account stands, then,—

(i) if the eligible amount in the account does not exceed Rupees five lakh, the Authorised Officer of the Accounts Office or the authority specified by the Government Savings Bank to which the Accounts Office belongs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, may pay the same to any person appearing to him as the rightful claimant and to his satisfaction to be entitled to receive the amount or to administer

the estate of the deceased, on an application in Form-11 accompanied by the following documents, namely:—

- (a) death certificate of the account holder;
- (b) passbook or deposit receipt or statement of account in original;
- (c) affidavit in Form-13;
- (d) letter of disclaimer in Form-14;
- (e) bond of indemnity in Form-15; and
- (f) identity proof of the legal heir;

Provided further that, in case of any dispute raised before the Accounts Office and before the payment of claim, the amount shall be paid by the Accounts Office to the claimant on submission of a succession certificate granted under the Indian Succession Act, 1925 (39 of 1925) issued by the Court only along with the following documents, namely:— (a) claim form; (b) pass book or deposit receipt or statement of account in original; (c) death certificate of the account holder; and (d) identity proof of the legal heir.

(ii) if the eligible amount in a deceased account is above Rupees five lakh, the amount shall be paid by the Accounts Office to the claimant on submission of the probate of his will or letters of administration of estate or a succession certificate granted under the Indian Succession Act, 1925 (39 of 1925) issued by the Court, or legal heir certificate issued by the revenue authority not below the rank of Tahsildar having jurisdiction along with the following documents, namely:—

- (a) claim form;
- (b) passbook or deposit receipt or statement of account in original;
- (c) death certificate of the account holder; and
- (d) identity proof of the legal heir;

Provided further that, in case of any dispute raised before the Accounts Office and before the payment of claim, the amount shall be paid by the Accounts Office to the claimant on submission of a succession certificate granted under the Indian Succession Act, 1925 (39 of 1925) issued by the court only along with the following documents, namely:— (a) claim form; (b) passbook or deposit receipt or statement of account in original; (c) death certificate of the account holder; and (d) identity proof of the legal heir.

(7) Surviving nominees will have to submit any of the identity documents prescribed in rule 6 of these rules.

■ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — Sub-rule (6) was substituted (adding the legal-heir certificate route, the Tahsildar option, identity-proof requirements and dispute provisos) and sub-rule (7) was inserted, both by G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (Second Amendment Rules, 2023; SB Order 16/2023), w.e.f. 03.07.2023.

16. Pledging of an account

(1) Where the provisions of the Savings Scheme so permit, an account may be pledged or transferred as security, on an application made by the depositor in Form-7 supported with acceptance letter from the pledgee, to the authorised officer of the Accounts Office.

(2) Transfer of an account under this rule may be made to —

- (a) the President of India or the Governor of a State in his official capacity;
- (b) the Reserve Bank of India or a Scheduled Bank or a Cooperative Society, including a Cooperative Bank;
- (c) a Public or Private Corporation or a Government Company;
- (d) a Local authority; or
- (e) a housing finance company approved by the National Housing Bank and notified by the Central Government:

Provided that the transfer of an account opened on behalf of a minor or a person of unsound mind shall not be permitted under this rule unless the guardian of the minor or the person of unsound mind, as the case may be, certifies that such transfer is for the use and benefit of the minor or the person of unsound mind.

(3) When any account is transferred as security under sub-rule (1), the authorised officer shall make the following endorsement in the record of the account, including the Savings Certificate, namely: — “Transferred as security to”.

(4) Except as otherwise provided in these rules, the transferee of an account under this rule shall, until it is re-transferred back under sub-rule (5), be deemed to be the depositor.

(5) An account transferred under this rule may, on written authority of the transferee, be re-transferred back with the previous sanction in writing of the authorised officer and when any such re-transfer is made, the authorised officer shall make the following endorsement, namely: — “Re-transferred to”.

(6) A blind or a person with physical infirmity making him incapable of operating the account may pledge his deposit through any literate individual whom he authorises for this purpose under rule 11.

17. Payment of the eligible balance in an account held by Army, Air Force and Navy personnel

(1) Notwithstanding anything contained in rules 14 and 15, where a depositor serving in the Army, Air Force or Navy dies or deserts, the Commanding Officer of the Corps, department, detachment, unit or ship to which the depositor belonged at the time of his death or desertion may make a requisition for the eligible balance to the authorised officer of the Accounts Office.

(2) The requisition under sub-rule (1) may be made under section 3 or section 4, as the case may be, of the Army and Air Force (Disposal of Private Property) Act, 1950 (40 of 1950) in the case of a depositor belonging to the Army or Air Force, and under section 3 or section 4, as the case may be, of the Navy (Disposal of Private Property) Act, 1956 (5 of 1956) in the case of a depositor belonging to the Navy.

(3) The authorised officer of the Accounts Office shall be bound to comply with such requisition even though there is in force at the time of death or desertion of the depositor a nomination made in favour of any other person, and the payment so made shall be a full discharge to the Accounts Office from all liability in respect of the eligible balance so paid.

18. Issue of Passbook

(1) On opening of an account, the depositor shall be issued a passbook or deposit receipt or statement of account as applicable to the Savings Scheme by the Accounts Office, and the passbook or deposit receipt or statement of account shall contain the following details, namely:—

- (a) Customer Identification number;
- (b) name and address of Accounts Office;
- (c) system generated unique accounts number;
- (d) name of the scheme;
- (e) name and address of the depositors;

- (f) type of account (single or joint-A or joint-B or minor or authorised);
 - (g) amount of deposit;
 - (h) date of deposit, date of extension and date of maturity;
 - (i) nomination registration number and date.
- (2) The passbook or deposit receipt or statement of account shall be duly stamped and signed by the authorised officer of the Accounts Office.
- (3) If the passbook or deposit receipt or statement of account is lost or stolen in custody of the depositor, a duplicate passbook or deposit receipt or statement of account may be issued on an application made to the Accounts Office on payment of the prescribed fee.
- (4) If a savings certificate issued prior to issue of these rules is lost or stolen or distorted or mutilated, a duplicate in the form of a passbook shall be issued on surrender of mutilated certificate or on submission of application along with the prescribed fee.
- (5) The Accounts Office shall not be liable for consequences of any unauthenticated entries in the passbook or deposit receipt or statement of account, or certificate, as the case may be.

19. Closure of account

- (1) The closure of an account shall be permitted on its maturity:

Provided that pre-mature closure of an account may be permitted if provided for in the Savings Scheme and subject to the conditions specified therein.

- (2) Payment of eligible balance under sub-rule (1) shall be made, at the option of depositors or guardian or nominee or legal heir, as the case may be, through any of the following means, namely:—

- (a) by transfer to the Savings Bank account of the payee;
 - (b) by a crossed cheque;
 - (c) by cash, if the amount is below the limit prescribed in this regard under the Income-tax Act, 1961.
- (3) Pre-mature closure of an account shall be permissible as per the provisions of the Savings Scheme.

20. Loans and partial withdrawal

(1) Loans and partial withdrawals from an account shall be allowed where permissible under the provisions of a Savings Scheme, and shall be subject to the conditions specified therein.

(2) In case of an account opened on behalf of a minor or a person of unsound mind, loan or partial withdrawal shall be permitted to the guardian on furnishing the following certificate, namely:—

"Certified that the amount sought to be withdrawn is required for the use and welfare of Shri/Smt./Master/Kumari who is a minor/a person of unsound mind/a person incapable of operating his account."

(3) In case of an account opened by a minor under sub-rule (1) of rule 4, the loan or partial withdrawal shall be permissible to the minor.

(4) A depositor suffering from physical infirmity, including blindness, that renders him incapable of operating his account, may avail the facility of loan or partial withdrawal through an individual authorised by him under rule 11.

21. Recovery of excess amount paid

Any amount not due but erroneously paid to a depositor, guardian, nominee or any other person authorised by the depositor shall be recoverable by the Government in the same manner as the arrears of land revenue.

22. Forms for operation

The forms prescribed for opening and operating the accounts are given in Schedule-I.

23. Fee for services

The fees shall be charged for rendering various services as specified in Schedule-II of these rules.

24. Responsibility of Accounts Office

(1) The Accounts Office shall be responsible for—

(a) opening of Accounts, accepting deposits, making payments of interest and maturity or prematurity proceeds, disbursal of loan or withdrawal, closing and

transferring accounts in conformity to these and scheme provisions and maintaining records thereof;

(b) providing services and facilities to the depositor as provided in these rules as well as in the provisions of the Savings Schemes.

■ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — *Clause (a) of sub-rule (1) was substituted by G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (Second Amendment Rules, 2023; SB Order 16/2023), w.e.f. 03.07.2023, to expand the enumerated responsibilities (interest, maturity/prematurity proceeds, disbursal of loan or withdrawal).*

(2) The Accounts Office shall furnish such data, reports, information, documents and evidence as may be required, and facilitate inspection of records, as may be deemed necessary in relation to any account or scheme.

(3) The Accounts Office shall create adequate technological infrastructure to carry out the provisions of these rules and those of various savings schemes, and to promote digital transactions by the depositors.

(4) If at any stage it is found that an account has been opened, or a deposit made, in contravention of the rules, the Accounts Office shall close the account forthwith and refund the amount deposited after deducting interest, if any, paid on such deposit.

(5) In case of any loss caused or liability incurred to the Government on account of non-implementation or wrong implementation of the provisions of the Act or any of the rules made thereunder, the Government shall be entitled to recover the loss from the person or persons responsible.

(6) The responsibility shall not vest with the Accounts Office under the following circumstances, namely:—

(a) for any fraudulent withdrawal by a person by obtaining possession of a passbook or savings certificate or the cheque book while in the custody of the depositor, and where the Accounts Office has acted in good faith;

(b) for any act, whatsoever, committed by a person or agent duly authorised by the depositor to act on his behalf with respect to the operation of an account;

(c) for any action taken in good faith by the Authorised Officer of the Accounts Office.

25. Applicability of old rules

In respect of a question or a matter relating to any of the Savings Scheme, prior to the date of commencement of these rules, the provisions of the Post Office Savings Bank General Rules, 1981 shall apply.

26. Repeal and savings

(1) The Post Office Savings Bank General Rules, 1981; the Post Office Savings Certificates Rules, 1960; and the Public Provident Fund Scheme, 1968 are hereby repealed.

(2) Notwithstanding such repeal, anything done or any action taken under the rules so repealed shall be deemed to have been done or taken under the corresponding provisions of these rules.

27. Interpretation

If any question arises relating to the interpretation of these rules or any rule or provision of a Savings Scheme, the Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance shall be the competent authority to decide the same.

28. Power to relax

Where the Central Government is satisfied that the operation of any of these rules or of any provision of a savings scheme causes undue hardship to a depositor or depositors of an account, it may, by order, for reasons to be recorded in writing, relax the requirements of that rule or provision in a manner not inconsistent with the provisions of the Act.

SCHEDULE-I

Forms to be used for operation of an account

Form No.	Purpose
GSPR-1	Opening of Account (AOF)
GSPR-2	Pay-in-slip (SB-103)
GSPR-3	Loan (SB-7C) / Withdrawal Form (SB-7)
GSPR-4	Pass Book (SB-5 & SB-5A)
GSPR-5	Application for Transfer of Account
GSPR-6	Application for Extension of Account
GSPR-7	Application for Pledging of Account
GSPR-8	Application for Premature closure of Account (SB-7B)
GSPR-9	Application for Final Withdrawal & Closure (SB-7A)
GSPR-10	Form for making nomination or Change or Cancellation of nomination
GSPR-11	Claim Form (Deceased)
GSPR-12	Form for authorisation of operation of account
GSPR-13	Affidavit
GSPR-14	Letter of disclaimer
GSPR-15	Bond of Indemnity
GSPR-16	Certificate to be issued by transferor Accounts Office (where account opening form is not traceable)

▣ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — Serial number 16 (Form GSPR-16) was inserted in Schedule-I, and Form-16 was inserted after Form-15, by G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (Second Amendment Rules, 2023; SB Order 16/2023), w.e.f. 03.07.2023.

SCHEDULE-II

Fee to be charged for services

(a)

- (i) Issue of duplicate pass book — ₹ 50.
- (ii) Issue of statement of account or deposit receipt — ₹ 20 in each case.
- (iii) Issue of pass book in lieu of lost or mutilated certificate — ₹ 10 per registration.

■ **AMENDMENT FLAG** — Clause (b) of Schedule-II — “Cancellation or change of nomination — ₹ 50” — was DELETED by the Government Savings Promotion General (Amendment) Rules, 2025, vide G.S.R. 214(E) dated 02.04.2025 (w.e.f. publication), circulated by SB Order 05/2025. Cancellation or change of nomination is therefore now free of charge. The clause is omitted below and subsequent clauses retain their original lettering as in the principal rules.

(c) Transfer of account — ₹ 100.

(d) Pledging of account — ₹ 100.

(e) Issue of cheque book in Savings Bank Account — No fee for up to 10 leaves in a calendar year and thereafter at ₹ 2 per cheque leaf.

(f) Charges on dishonour of cheque — ₹ 100.

(g) Goods and Services Tax at 18% on the above service charges shall also be payable.

(h) Charge for non-maintenance of minimum balance — ₹ 50 (inclusive of GST).

Editorial Note on Currency

This compilation reproduces the Government Savings Promotion General Rules, 2018 as amended by G.S.R. 238(E) dated 31.03.2023 (First Amendment), G.S.R. 488(E) dated 03.07.2023 (Second Amendment) and G.S.R. 214(E) dated 02.04.2025 (Amendment of 2025). All amendable provisions were verified against primary gazette sources and Department of Posts SB Orders as on 15 June 2026. No further amendment to these Rules was traced after G.S.R. 214(E) as on the verification date.